GLOBAL INTELLIGENCE

Daily Intelligence Report

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At a Glance

- **Oil drops on unconfirmed Iran signals:** Brent fell about 3.5% to roughly $94.7 after unsourced reports that Tehran had softened its Hormuz demands. Trump called a large-scale strike "highly unlikely" if Iran signs a "very solid" deal. Iran told the UN nuclear watchdog (IAEA) it need not accept full monitoring under US threat, so no deal is confirmed.
- **Nvidia crisis:** CEO Jensen Huang admitted an affair with a woman reported to be a suspected Chinese spy, which is unproven. The board has opened an investigation, and the shares fell about 6% pre-market. Bloomberg puts the loss at about $200bn of market value.
- **Race to succeed Lagarde at the ECB:** Eurozone finance ministers began a first assessment of Spain's Pablo Hernández de Cos and the Netherlands' Klaas Knot. Lagarde is reported to leave in February 2027, and Italy has no candidate.
- **Italian banks surge:** Milan's FTSE MIB rose about 2% to above 51,000. Banco BPM gained about 10% on a friendly merger proposal from Crédit Agricole, and UniCredit rose 5.6% after record results.
- **Ukraine talks in Abu Dhabi:** US, Ukrainian and Russian officials are due to meet, reportedly on 10–11 November. The EU is sending two senior officials. Meanwhile Russia launched 317 long-range drones overnight, and Kyiv hit the Kirishi refinery.
- **Pro-Russian hackers target Italy:** Hackers posted personal data on Foreign Minister Tajani and 17 other officials. Interior Minister Piantedosi convenes the national security committee on Tuesday.

- **Democrats win Congress:** They took the House in the 3 November midterms (at least 228 seats). They can probe Trump's tariffs, but most tariffs rest on executive authority.
- **US–China truce extended:** Beijing keeps its extra 24% tariff suspended until January. A 10% rate stays. The Xi–Trump meeting is reportedly at the APEC summit in Shenzhen on 18–19 November.
- **South Africa's ANC posts its worst result:** It won 30.76% in the local elections, against 46% in 2021. The party is reviewing its national coalition with the Democratic Alliance (DA).
- **European gas storage is a worry:** TTF gas is near €84–87/MWh. The IEA says EU storage entered winter at its lowest level since 2013.

Contents

What It Means for You in Italy 4

Markets Dashboard 5

I. Europe & Italy

Italy 7

European Union 9

Italy in the EU & PNRR 10

Across Europe 11

II. Great Powers

United States 13

China 14

Russia & Ukraine 15

III. World Regions

Middle East & Gulf 18

Indo-Pacific 19

BRICS+ & Global South 20

Africa 21

Latin America 22

IV. Security, Technology & Space

Defence & Security 23

Cyber & Information Warfare 24

Fact Check 25

Technology & AI 26

Space 27

V. Economy, Markets & Energy

Global Economy & Central Banks 29

Markets & Finance 30

Trade, Tariffs & Sanctions 31

Energy & Critical Minerals 32

VI. Outlook

Market Implications 34
Market Opportunities & Risks 35
Scenarios 36
What to Watch 37
Explained 38
Glossary 40

What It Means for You in Italy

- **Fuel and heating:** Brent below $95 (it peaked near $110 this year) could ease pump prices over the coming weeks. The move rests on unconfirmed reports and could reverse quickly.
- **Gas and electricity bills:** TTF gas near €84–87/MWh is still high. Low EU storage means winter and next summer's refilling could keep bills elevated. No tariff change has been announced.
- **Mortgages and loans:** The ECB's next meeting is 17 December. A rate rise has been discussed, so variable-rate mortgages remain exposed. The ECB leadership race adds no near-term change.
- **Savings and BTPs:** The 10-year BTP yields about 4.31%, with a spread of about 106–108 points over the Bund. That is stable, but a surprise in US inflation data on Tuesday could move it.
- **Prices:** Energy-driven inflation is the main risk. Lower oil helps, but the euro-area inflation figure of 4.0% for October comes from a single source and is unverified.
- **Jobs and industry:** Intesa Sanpaolo and Prometeia see industrial turnover at a record €1,168bn in 2026, up 0.8%. That is modest growth, not a hiring boom.
- **Taxes and pensions:** The 2027 budget (about €26bn) must pass the Chamber and Senate by 31 December. Debate on pensions and schools continues, and nothing is final.
- **Digital security:** Expect tighter cyber measures after Tuesday's committee. No direct risk to individuals has been reported.

Markets Dashboard

Europe	Last	Day	Week
Euro Stoxx 50	6,244.98	+1.21%	+1.12%
FTSE MIB (Italy)	51,030.92	+1.95%	+2.17%
DAX (Germany)	26,076.95	+0.99%	+0.37%
CAC 40 (France)	8,195.67	+0.70%	+1.84%
IBEX 35 (Spain)	19,645.70	+1.43%	+3.63%
FTSE 100 (UK)	10,736.93	+0.59%	-0.23%

Americas	Last	Day	Week
S&P 500	7,376.86	+0.31%	-2.68%
Nasdaq 100	26,989.99	+1.35%	-4.91%
VIX (US volatility)	23.22	-9.44%	+9.79%
Bovespa (Brazil)	169,351.52	+0.51%	+0.85%

Asia	Last	Day	Week
Nikkei 225 (Japan)	58,775.50	+2.33%	-7.13%
CSI 300 (China)	4,056.11	–	–
Hang Seng (Hong Kong)	24,448.95	-0.13%	+4.51%
KOSPI (South Korea)	5,018.85	-0.81%	-14.34%
Taiex (Taiwan)	41,661.70	+4.94%	-7.25%
Nifty 50 (India)	25,044.65	+0.06%	+6.84%

Rates	Last	Day	Week
US 10Y yield (%)	4.8590	+0.45%	-1.42%
US 2Y yield (%)	4.7750	+0.00%	+4.42%

Currencies	Last	Day	Week
EUR/USD	1.1197	-0.28%	+0.36%
EUR/GBP	0.8342	-0.03%	+0.09%
EUR/CHF	0.9164	+0.09%	-0.40%
EUR/CNY	7.4721	-0.50%	+0.55%
US Dollar Index (DXY)	101.85	-0.44%	+0.10%
USD/JPY	157.93	+0.27%	+0.16%
USD/CNH	6.6705	–	–
USD/RUB	82.39	+1.10%	+2.12%
USD/INR	93.93	-0.56%	-1.03%
USD/BRL	5.5090	+0.10%	+1.36%
USD/TRY	50.17	+0.04%	+0.41%
Bitcoin ($)	74,553.70	-0.04%	-7.28%

Commodities	Last	Day	Week
Brent ($/bbl)	94.39	-4.00%	-9.91%
WTI ($/bbl)	87.69	-3.46%	-9.09%
Dutch TTF gas (EUR/MWh)	84.28	-1.53%	-11.15%
Gold ($/oz)	4,130.30	+1.36%	+4.05%
Silver ($/oz)	52.55	+1.44%	+3.61%
Copper ($/lb)	6.3110	+1.50%	-3.55%
Wheat (c/bu)	589.00	-0.38%	-2.89%

Delayed exchange quotes, last daily close (Yahoo Finance). Prices, not policy facts.

I Europe & Italy

Italy

Italian assets rallied on Monday as oil fell and banks surged. The government is also dealing with a wave of pro-Russian cyber activity and preparing a reform of the provinces.

Milan jumps 2% on banks as oil falls

Milan's FTSE MIB rose about 2% by midday to above 51,000 points. Banco BPM jumped on bank consolidation talk ("risiko bancario"), and UniCredit rose after its results. The BTP-Bund spread, the yield gap between Italian and German 10-year bonds, was 106-108 basis points. The Italian 10-year yield was 4.31% at the open. Brent crude fell about 3.5% to below $95 after unconfirmed reports that Iran had softened its demands over the Strait of Hormuz.

Why it matters: The spread is a gauge of the extra return investors demand to hold Italian rather than German debt. It is stable near recent levels, and lower energy prices help Italy, a large gas and oil importer.

Market impact: Banks led the rise. Dutch TTF gas, the European benchmark, opened up 1.2% at €86.63/MWh. Bloomberg reports European storage could be at its lowest in more than a decade by spring.

Watch: Banking deal announcements, and whether the Hormuz reports are confirmed.

Sources: ANSA, ANSA spread, ANSA oil, Bloomberg

Cyber threat: Piantedosi convenes security committee

Interior Minister Matteo Piantedosi has called the national committee for public order and security for Tuesday 10 November to assess cyber risks to public safety. The Record reports that pro-Russian hackers published personal data of Foreign Minister Antonio Tajani and other senior European officials on the dark web. They offered cryptocurrency rewards for more details on the officials and their families. Il Sole 24 Ore reports

that Z-Pentest, which with NoName057(16) claimed attacks on European industrial systems, was described by the US Justice Department as "founded, financed and directed" by Russia's military intelligence (GRU). Separately, a bill to strengthen military cyber capacity, with about 1,200 specialists, is heading for a Senate vote in December.

Why it matters: Most NoName attacks so far have been denial-of-service floods that knock sites offline. Publishing personal data is a step towards intimidation.

Watch: Outcomes of Tuesday's committee.

Sources: Il Sole 24 Ore, The Record, Il Sole 24 Ore Z-Pentest, ANSA

Government prepares direct election of provincial presidents

Il Sole 24 Ore reports a reform, headed for an upcoming cabinet meeting, that restores citizen votes for provincial presidents and councils. A candidate winning more than 40% would be elected without a runoff, with a 60% majority bonus.

Why it matters: Provinces have been run by indirectly elected local officials since the 2014 Delrio law.

Budget and industry

The 2027 budget, approved by cabinet on 28 October and worth about €26bn, is now in the Chamber of Deputies. It must pass by 31 December to avoid provisional budgeting (Teleborsa and trade press reports). Intesa Sanpaolo and Prometeia see industrial turnover heading for a record €1,168bn, up 0.8% in 2026. Intesa's chief economist says manufactured exports rose €216bn between 2015 and 2025.

Sources: ANSA, Il Sole 24 Ore, Il Sole 24 Ore provinces, Teleborsa

European Union

Finance ministers open the race to succeed Lagarde at the ECB

Euro-zone finance ministers began a first assessment of the European Central Bank presidency. Spain has nominated Pablo Hernández de Cos, head of the Bank for International Settlements. The Netherlands has nominated Klaas Knot, a former Dutch central bank governor. Handelsblatt says the timetable is tight and a decision should come soon, followed by other top appointments. Lagarde is reported to be leaving in February 2027. EIB president Nadia Calviño told Bloomberg that the successor must follow Lagarde's approach.

Why it matters: The ECB president sets the tone for interest rates for 20 countries. Analysts quoted by Reuters-linked outlets see the two as close on policy, Knot slightly more hawkish (favouring tighter policy) and de Cos slightly more dovish. The choice is formally made by EU leaders, so it is also a political bargain over top jobs.

For Europe & Italy: Italy, whose borrowing costs depend on ECB policy, has no candidate and will be a swing vote in the bargaining.

Watch: The next Eurogroup and Ecofin statements, and any move by Germany, which has been floated through Bundesbank chief Joachim Nagel.

Sources: Bloomberg, Handelsblatt, Bloomberg Calviño, DutchNews

EU sends two senior officials to Abu Dhabi talks on Ukraine

Politico reports that officials from the European Commission and the Council will attend trilateral talks between Ukraine, Russia and the US in Abu Dhabi. The FT says the aim is to counter Russian security demands.

Why it matters: Europe has so far been a bystander in US-led negotiations, though it would bear much of the cost and security burden of any settlement.

Watch: Whether the Europeans get a seat at the table or stay in observer roles.

Sources: Politico Europe, FT

Defence and tech industrial moves

Dutch start-up Onodrim, founded by Palantir alumni, raised $300mn at a $1.3bn valuation to buy and scale smaller European defence firms (FT). Ardian raised €1bn for its first semiconductor fund with Middle East backing (Bloomberg). Handelsblatt notes China's dominance of battery supply chains is a risk for Ukrainian drone production. Politico reports the Kremlin is recruiting ordinary civilians for sabotage across Europe.

Sources: FT, Bloomberg, Handelsblatt, Politico

Italy in the EU & PNRR

Italy is still in the EU's excessive deficit procedure. In June the Commission said Rome had taken effective measures but kept the procedure open. Italian press put the 2025 deficit at 3.1% of GDP, per Eurostat. The 2027 budget plan is reported to target a deficit of 2.8%. The Commission's formal opinion on Italy's draft budget has not appeared in my searches. Under past practice it comes in the late-November autumn package. Italian press also reported a first Commission green light to use the fiscal "escape clause" for extra defence and energy spending (ItaliaOggi cites €28.8bn). I could not verify that figure independently.

On Monday Italy's position in Brussels mattered mainly for the ECB race. Spain and the Netherlands have candidates, and Italy has none.

PNRR tracker

The PNRR is Italy's share of the EU recovery fund, worth €194.4bn in total. Italy submitted its tenth and final payment request on 29 September. It is worth €28.4bn and covers 156 targets that, according to Minister Tommaso Foti, have been reached. The Commission is now assessing the request. Italy had received its ninth instalment on 3 June, bringing the total received to about €166bn (Chamber of Deputies figures). I found no news today of the Commission's assessment.

Item	Status	Next step
10th (final) instalment, €28.4bn	Request filed 29 Sep, under Commission review	Commission assessment, then Council/committee opinion and payment
9th instalment	Paid in June	Nothing outstanding
EU programme deadline	Payments must end in 2026	Closing audits and any reprogramming

Watch: The Commission's preliminary assessment of the tenth instalment, and the autumn-package opinion on the budget.

Sources: Teleborsa, Agenzia Nova, Teleborsa EDP, ItaliaOggi

Across Europe

Germany

Chancellor Friedrich Merz's CDU has nominated Ilse Aigner, the CSU president of the Bavarian state parliament, as its candidate for federal president. Merz was due to propose her formally on Monday. The coalition leaders and the Greens back her. Aigner criticised the chancellor's long hesitation, according to Handelsblatt. The Federal Assembly vote is set for 30 January 2027, and Frank-Walter Steinmeier's term ends on 18 March. Separately, the IG Metall union and Bavaria's metal and electrical employers ended a third round of pay talks without a result, and talks begin in North Rhine-Westphalia. BMW will buy battery cells from Samsung and LG Energy to reduce reliance on China.

Sources: Handelsblatt, Handelsblatt, Handelsblatt IG Metall, Handelsblatt BMW, Schwäbische

United Kingdom

Politico's podcast frames Prime Minister Andy Burnham as facing a hard road on his 10-year plan and welfare reforms, with a UK-EU summit on the horizon. The FT reports an exodus of China specialists from the Foreign Office, weakening policy at a sensitive time.

Sources: Politico Europe, FT

Netherlands and Spain

The Hague and Madrid are lobbying for their ECB candidates, Knot and de Cos (see the European Union section). The Dutch defence start-up Onodrim is also in the news (see above).

Sources: Handelsblatt

Across the continent

European stock markets were weak at the open (Paris -0.39%, London -0.18%, Frankfurt -0.02%) and rose later as oil fell. Politico reports that Russian-recruited low-level agents are being used for sabotage in several countries.

Sources: ANSA, Politico

II Great Powers

United States

Democrats won control of Congress in the 3 November midterms. Scripps News reported at least 228 House seats, against 218 needed for a majority. Hakeem Jeffries is positioned to become Speaker in January. Trump said on social media that he was not on the ballot. Voters cited high prices, the conflict involving Iran and corruption allegations.

Democratic Congress puts Trump's tariffs under pressure

The new majority takes office in January, so Trump's tariffs and other policies will face scrutiny. The FT argues the Democrats may be content to reverse the duties on Canada, a "partial return to tariff sanity". Bloomberg Economics says the vote signalled populist priorities on cost of living. Tariffs are a likely flashpoint because they raise consumer prices.

Why it matters: Congress holds the budget and oversight powers. A hostile House can open investigations and block spending. Tariffs, however, rest largely on executive authority, so Trump can still act without Congress.

For Europe & Italy: Europe is under a US tariff regime and wants it stable. A Congress that questions Trump's trade moves could reduce the risk of new escalation. It cannot by itself remove existing duties on EU goods. The Italian export sectors most exposed are machinery, food and luxury goods.

Watch: The final seat counts, and whether Democrats move to curb tariffs through votes or hearings once sworn in.

Sources: Scripps News, FT, Bloomberg

Nvidia chief's admission of an affair draws in Congress and the Justice Department

On 8 November, Nvidia CEO Jensen Huang admitted being unfaithful in his marriage. This effectively confirmed reports linking him to Alice Huang, a former executive at Singapore-based data-centre firm Megaspeed. Reports describe her as a suspected Chinese spy, which remains unproven, and say she is unrelated to him. Nvidia is the world's second-most-valuable company, and its shares fell in Monday trading. Bloomberg reports that three House committee chairs asked Huang on 5 November for a closed-door briefing, and that the Justice Department is investigating Megaspeed.

Why it matters: Megaspeed rents advanced chips to Chinese firms, so the case revives questions about US export controls.

Market impact: Nvidia shares fell on Monday. Handelsblatt says investors are also nervous about other large tech stocks.

Watch: The House briefing and any export-control action.

Sources: Bloomberg, Handelsblatt

China

China's economy is sending mixed signals. Factory-gate inflation is climbing while demand stays weak, and Beijing is trying to keep the trade truce with Washington on track before a Xi–Trump meeting.

Beijing extends its tariff pause with the US for two months

China will suspend retaliatory measures, including an additional 24% tariff on US goods, for another two months. This formalises a leaders' decision to prolong the truce until January. Bloomberg says a 10% rate stays in place. Soybean traders are watching for Chinese farm purchases, which Washington is pressing for.

Why it matters: The truce dates from the October 2025 Busan meeting. A lapse would have meant new tariffs and possible curbs on rare earths, which Europe's carmakers and defence firms also depend on. Other reports say the new deadline is 10 January 2027. Tariffs, rare earths and tech curbs are still unresolved.

Market impact: Soybean futures erased earlier gains as the pause was offset by expectations of a large US crop.

Watch: The Xi–Trump meeting, due a little over a week away according to Bloomberg.

Sources: Bloomberg, Bloomberg

Producer prices hit a four-year high but demand stays weak

Producer inflation accelerated to the fastest since June 2022 (Bloomberg's headline gives 5.7%), driven by costlier energy. Consumer-price growth slowed. The FT calls it weak domestic demand amid an energy crisis. Bloomberg Economics labels this "bad inflation": costs rise but demand does not support higher prices, so deflation risks remain.

Why it matters: Higher input costs squeeze margins without lifting spending. That limits Beijing's room for stimulus.

Sources: Bloomberg, FT

Beijing calls the Nvidia spy claims "smears"

China dismissed allegations that it spied on Nvidia's CEO as baseless. A Chinese newspaper warned on ties, per Bloomberg. Handelsblatt reports that investors are pulling money from Chinese AI stocks despite state investment.

Watch: Whether the episode hardens US chip-export policy before the summit.

Sources: Bloomberg, Handelsblatt

Russia & Ukraine

Diplomacy and fighting are running in parallel. Trilateral talks among the US, Ukraine and Russia are due in Abu Dhabi, with reports pointing to 10–11 November. Russia is hitting Ukrainian energy and Ukraine is hitting Russian refineries.

Europeans join the Abu Dhabi talks

Politico reports that the EU is sending two senior officials, from the European Commission and the Council, to the talks. The FT says the Europeans want to thwart Russian security demands. Politico's Brussels Playbook says the stakes are high, with Europe's future in the balance.

Why it matters: Until now Europe has largely watched talks between Washington, Moscow and Kyiv from outside. Any deal on security guarantees or troop deployments would fall largely on Europeans to implement. Territory has been the central dispute in earlier rounds: Moscow has demanded that Ukraine leave Donbas.

For Europe & Italy: Rome would have to share the cost and political risk of any postwar guarantees.

Watch: Whether the EU officials get a seat in the room or stay on the sidelines.

Sources: Politico Europe, FT

Strikes continue on both sides

Ukraine's Air Force said Russia launched 317 long-range drones overnight into 9 November, 105 of them jet-powered. On 8 November, 164 drones were launched and 137 shot down, AP reported. Zelensky said more than 600,000 people lost power in Dnipropetrovsk region. He also condemned a strike on emergency crews at Komyshuvakha, near the front in Zaporizhzhia. Kyiv's drones hit the Kirishi refinery, which Russia's governor called its second-largest.

Sources: Kyiv Independent, Inquirer/AP

Hybrid attacks: officials' data leaked, Estonia alleges terrorism

Pro-Russian hackers published the personal data of Foreign Minister Antonio Tajani and other European officials, offering crypto rewards for more, The Record reports. Il Sole 24 Ore says the Z-Pentest group, which with NoName057(16) claimed the hacking of European supermarket fridges, was "founded, financed and directed" by the GRU, according to the US Justice Department. Estonia accused Russia of state-sponsored terrorism, the FT reports.

Watch: Attribution findings from European investigators.

Sources: The Record, Il Sole 24 Ore, FT

III World Regions

Middle East & Gulf

The US–Iran war, which began in late February, is still the main driver of Gulf security and oil prices. The Strait of Hormuz, the Gulf's oil export route, has been largely disrupted since the war started. Gaza, Lebanon and Syria produced no verified developments in today's window.

Oil falls on reports of Iranian flexibility over Hormuz

ANSA reported at about 13:00 Italy time that Brent fell about 3.5% to roughly $94.7 a barrel, and WTI fell about 3% to about $88. The drop followed unconfirmed reports that Iran had softened its demands on the strait. The reports named no source and gave no detail. Over the weekend Trump called a large-scale attack on Iran "highly unlikely", but only if Tehran signs a "very solid" deal.

Why it matters: Brent had already been sliding this morning. Traders are pricing the chance of a deal after the US midterm elections, not confirmed progress.

For Europe & Italy: Lower crude and gas prices ease pressure on Italian energy bills and on inflation in the euro area.

Watch: Any official confirmation from Tehran, Washington or Oman, which has mediated on Hormuz.

Sources: ANSA, ANSA

Houthis hit Aramco tower in Riyadh; Iran hardens line on inspectors

BBC Verify authenticated footage showing damage to the Aramco tower in Riyadh's central financial district. The Houthis (Iran-aligned rebels who control much of Yemen) had launched fresh strikes. This is the first reported hit on the capital's financial core in this campaign. Earlier reporting described a Houthi campaign against Saudi oil sites and Red

Sea ports. In a separate report to the IAEA (the UN nuclear watchdog), Iran said it is not obliged to accept full monitoring while under US military threat, according to Bloomberg.

Why it matters: Together, the Houthi strikes and Iran's stance on inspectors undercut the deal hopes behind today's oil drop.

Market impact: A deal would push oil lower. Houthi attacks on Saudi export routes push it higher.

Watch: Saudi retaliation, and any IAEA Board response.

Sources: BBC, Bloomberg

COP31 opens in Antalya, Turkey

The UN climate conference opens this week under a "terrible backdrop", per the FT. Europe has lowered its ambitions and is holding back on new climate finance.

Sources: FT, Japan Times

Indo-Pacific

Markets are rebounding after last week's tech selloff, and Asia's chip supply chain is being reshaped by both politics and industrial deals.

Nvidia faces a crisis over CEO Jensen Huang's affair and a suspected Chinese spy

Huang admitted an affair with a woman identified in media reports as a suspected Chinese spy. Bloomberg describes her as Alice Huang, a former television journalist who became a broker renting advanced chips to Chinese firms. Japan Times reports that Nvidia is caught up in a Chinese spying probe. Nvidia shares fell. Huang told staff the company faces a crisis unlike any in its three-decade history.

Why it matters: Nvidia is central to the AI boom and to US export controls on chips to China. The case could prompt scrutiny of who had access to those chips.

Market impact: Nvidia fell. Tokyo's Nikkei still closed up 2.33%, with chip stocks rebounding and the yen firmer.

Watch: Any US regulatory or congressional response, and board action.

Sources: Bloomberg, Japan Times, ANSA

Mitsui Chemicals to take over JSR for $12 billion

Mitsui Chemicals plans to buy JSR, a key supplier of chip materials. The deal furthers a government-backed push to consolidate Japan's fragmented semiconductor-materials industry. Separately, BMW will buy battery cells from Samsung and LG Energy to reduce dependence on China.

Sources: Japan Times, Handelsblatt

Smaller items

- **Bangladesh:** Ousted prime minister Sheikh Hasina has asked for a new passport and ID card, a step that could ease a return more than two years after she fled to India. *Bloomberg*
- **Australia:** A Reserve Bank of Australia official said AI-related investment will add near-term price pressure while policymakers are aggressively raising rates. *Bloomberg*
- **Japan–China:** A year after Prime Minister Takaichi's Taiwan remarks, Beijing still blames Tokyo for the rift (SCMP).

BRICS+ & Global South

BRICS+ has no summit this week. The bloc's members are pulled in different directions by the Iran war, Ukraine diplomacy and domestic politics.

- **Brazil:** President Lula, re-elected to a fourth term, promised fiscal responsibility in his first televised address. Economists raised their year-end interest-rate forecasts for the second week running, betting that high public spending will push up inflation. *Bloomberg, Bloomberg*
- **South Africa:** Police stopped nine foreigners, none of them residents, who were allegedly trying to leave to fight in Ukraine. Pretoria's coalition faces strain after the ANC's election setback (see Africa). *BBC*

- **Gulf and Iran:** Iran, a BRICS member, is at war with the US. The UAE, another member, is hosting the Ukraine–Russia–US talks in Abu Dhabi, which the EU is joining. Middle Eastern investors backed Ardian's new €1 billion European chip fund. *Politico Europe, Bloomberg*

No verified news on the New Development Bank or de-dollarisation today.

Africa

South Africa's ANC posts its worst result; coalition with the DA under review

Final results from the local elections, as reported by South African outlets, give the ANC 30.76% and the Democratic Alliance (DA) 24.64%. The uMkhonto weSizwe (MK) party, linked to former president Jacob Zuma, took 9.76%. In 2021 the ANC won 46%. The DA won Cape Town, Johannesburg, Tshwane, Ekurhuleni and Nelson Mandela Bay, and MK won eThekwini. The BBC reports Ramaphosa said the verdict must be respected, while the party's secretary-general called it "catastrophic". Bloomberg says the ANC will consider ending its national coalition with the DA, and that the question has become a fault line in the race to succeed Ramaphosa.

Why it matters: The ANC and DA have governed together nationally since 2024. A break would threaten the reform agenda and investor confidence in Africa's most industrialised economy.

Watch: Municipal coalition talks and the ANC's internal review.

Sources: BBC, Bloomberg, Nowinsa

Nigeria and migration

Nigerian President Bola Tinubu unveiled cost-of-living pledges ahead of January elections. *Bloomberg*

At least 34 people died when a Europe-bound migrant boat sank off Senegal. The route to Spain's Canary Islands remains deadly. *BBC*

Kenya seized 454 kg of methamphetamine after a suspect was arrested in Tanzania. *BBC*

I found no verified new developments today on Sudan, the DRC or the Sahel.

Latin America

Lula re-elected, markets focus on spending

Lula won a fourth term and used his first televised address to pledge to protect public finances without cutting social programmes. Economists nonetheless raised their 2026 year-end rate forecasts for the second straight week. They fear high public spending will keep inflation up.

Why it matters: Brazil's central bank may need to keep rates high for longer. The tension between fiscal discipline and social spending will shape the real and Brazilian bonds.

Market impact: Rate expectations are rising. A5X, a startup exchange, will launch MSCI index derivatives next year, challenging the incumbent B3.

Sources: Bloomberg, Bloomberg

Argentina: Pope Leo and Milei

Pope Leo gave a speech in Argentina that many read as veiled criticism of President Javier Milei's austerity, according to the FT.

Sources: FT

US politics and the region

After the midterms, Trump said he was "too tough" on immigrants and floated an amnesty deal. That could ease pressure on Mexico and Central America. Since the US captured Venezuela's Maduro in January, Washington's hemispheric role has been more assertive.

In Chile, exporters, who sell about 70% of their wine abroad, are pulling up vines as global demand falls.

Sources: FT, Bloomberg

IV Security, Technology & Space

Defence & Security

Iran's standoff with the US, Europe's hybrid-war alarm and a defence-tech funding wave were the main security stories of the window. I found no verified battlefield update from Ukraine in the last 24 hours, so none is included.

Iran hardens its line on nuclear monitoring while its president signals openness to talks

Bloomberg reports that Iran told the International Atomic Energy Agency (IAEA, the UN nuclear watchdog) it is not obliged to accept full monitoring while it is under threat of US military attack. The same day, Iranian state media quoted President Masoud Pezeshkian saying Supreme Leader Ali Khamenei had ordered an end to the "neither war nor peace" limbo with Washington. He said Iran can open talks "on equal terms" but will never submit to force. No US response was reported.

Why it matters: The IAEA has had no access to the sites bombed in 2025, and in earlier reports it asked Tehran to account for its enriched uranium. The two messages together suggest Iran is hardening its position on inspections while saying it is open to negotiation.

For Europe & Italy: European governments and the IAEA have pushed Iran to restart inspections. A failure of diplomacy would raise Gulf energy and shipping risks.

Watch: Any US reply to Pezeshkian, and the next IAEA Board of Governors discussion.

Sources: Bloomberg, ANSA

Italy and Europe treat cyber sabotage as part of hybrid war

Interior Minister Matteo Piantedosi has convened the national public-order and security committee for Tuesday 10 November to assess cyber risks. Foreign Minister Antonio Tajani said G7 foreign ministers meeting in Paris would discuss joint countermeasures. In the Senate, the

governing majority wants a December vote on a bill to build a force of about 1,200 military cyber specialists. The Financial Times reports that Estonia accused Russia of "state-sponsored terrorism" over hybrid attacks. Details are in the Cyber section.

Why it matters: Cyber duties in Italy are split among several agencies, which the defence minister, Guido Crosetto, wants to coordinate better.

Watch: The outcome of the 10 November committee and the G7 statement.

Sources: Il Sole 24 Ore, ANSA, FT

Defence-industry capital keeps flowing

Dutch start-up Onodrim, founded by Palantir alumni, raised $300 million at a $1.3 billion valuation. It plans to buy and scale smaller European defence firms to expand production capacity. In the US, War on the Rocks says the Pentagon is sending record munitions demand signals, but many sub-tier suppliers have disappeared over two decades.

Market impact: Shows private capital still moving into European defence supply chains.

Sources: FT, War on the Rocks

Cyber & Information Warfare

Pro-Russian hackers publish data on Tajani and European officials

The Record reports that hackers linked to NoName057(16) posted contact details, and in some cases home addresses, of 18 people on the dark web. The list includes Tajani, Rome prosecutor Francesco Lo Voi, Italy's Postal Police chief, Eurojust's president and Europol's cybercrime chief. It offers cryptocurrency rewards for more information on them and their families. Tajani called it intimidation over Italy's support for Ukraine. Italian prosecutors are investigating. He said he has no proof of Russian government involvement, and Moscow denies any.

Why it matters: The campaign looks like retaliation for the July 2025 Europol operation that took over 100 servers offline.

Sources: The Record

Who is behind the supermarket freezer attacks?

NoName057(16) and Z-Pentest claimed attacks that disrupted refrigeration at supermarkets in several European countries, Italy among them. The video claim is not independently verified. Il Sole 24 Ore notes that US prosecutors, in a December 2025 indictment, described Z-Pentest as "founded, financed and directed" by the GRU, Russian military intelligence. The Kremlin rejects the suspicions. Attribution of this specific campaign is still under investigation.

Watch: Any formal attribution from the G7 or EU.

Sources: Il Sole 24 Ore

Russian units use deepfakes to claim battlefield wins

The FT reports that army units and pro-war bloggers are posting videos that researchers say have been manipulated.

Sources: FT

Fact Check

"Russia's GRU hacked Europe's supermarket fridges"

Verdict: Unproven

What is actually true: NoName057(16) and Z-Pentest claimed the attacks in a video that has not been independently verified. Some researchers suspect the groups claimed credit after the incidents were reported. The US indictment of Z-Pentest predates these events. Tajani said he has no proof of Russian government involvement.

Why it matters: Hacktivist groups gain from exaggerated claims, and states gain deniability.

Sources: Il Sole 24 Ore, The Record

"Nvidia's CEO is proven to have passed secrets to China"

Verdict: Unproven

What is actually true: Jensen Huang admitted an affair. A woman identified as a suspected Chinese spy was named in press reports, which rest on anonymous sources. Nvidia says it has no reason to believe trade secrets or US security were compromised. Beijing calls the claims "smears".

Why it matters: Political pressure ahead of a Xi–Trump meeting is fuelling the story.

Sources: Handelsblatt, Bloomberg

"A foreign Wi-Fi device was found in a Michigan vote tabulator"

Verdict: False

What is actually true: Media Bias/Fact Check's roundup of 6 November found no evidence of such a signal.

Why it matters: Election-fraud rumours spread quickly after the 3 November vote.

Sources: MBFC

Technology & AI

Nvidia faces its biggest crisis as its board probes CEO Huang

Jensen Huang admitted on 8 November to infidelity after reports linked him to a woman described as a suspected Chinese spy. Nvidia's board has opened an investigation. The company says it has no reason to think trade secrets or US security were compromised. Huang is cooperating and stays in post. Shares fell about 6% in pre-market trading, according to ANSA. Bloomberg puts the damage at $200 billion of market value. China's state-backed press calls the claims baseless "smears", a little over a week before a Xi–Trump meeting.

Why it matters: Nvidia supplies most of the world's AI accelerators. It is also the focus of US debate over chip exports to China.

For Europe & Italy: European AI data-centre builders depend on Nvidia supply and on a stable US–China relationship.

Market impact: Chip stocks led last week's selloff, the S&P 500's worst since April 2025. S&P futures were up 0.7% on Monday as buyers returned. The Dax was back above 26,000.

Watch: Reported US House committee requests for Huang to brief lawmakers around 18 November, and the Xi–Trump meeting.

Sources: ANSA, Bloomberg, FT, Handelsblatt

Google widens its TPU line against Nvidia

Alphabet's Google is rolling out a broader range of its TPU (tensor processing unit) AI chips, as Bloomberg describes it, to challenge Nvidia in a market worth hundreds of billions of dollars.

Sources: Bloomberg

Japan consolidates chip materials; Europe raises chip capital

Mitsui Chemicals plans to take over chip-materials maker JSR for $12 billion, part of a government-backed push to consolidate Japan's fragmented industry. Ardian raised €1 billion for its first European semiconductor fund, with significant Middle East backing.

Sources: Japan Times, Bloomberg

AI politics and inflation

The FT says analysts see a "window to catch up" for China if newly elected Democrats take a tougher line on US data-centre construction. An Australian central-bank official said the AI investment boom will add near-term price pressure.

Sources: FT, Bloomberg

Space

No major launch or mission result was confirmed in the window.

NASA opens a $1 million Moon Base Student Challenge

NASA Administrator Jared Isaacman announced the competition on 8 November at Kennedy Space Center. US high-school and college teams can submit designs in six areas: power, construction, life support, surface mobility, communications and astronaut safety. Registration closes on 25 January 2027.

Why it matters: It supports NASA's lunar-base ambitions.

Sources: NASA

Mars simulation ends; ozone hole peaks

Four volunteers left NASA's CHAPEA Mars habitat on 31 October after 378 days. NASA also says the 2026 ozone hole was the seventh largest in 48 years of records, though shallower than other large holes.

Sources: NASA, NASA Earth Observatory

Watch: A tracker reported ULA's Vulcan returning to flight on 13 November, pending range approval. That date is unconfirmed.

V Economy, Markets & Energy

Global Economy & Central Banks

Inflation is the common thread. Oil and gas prices, pushed up by the US-Iran conflict and disruption around the Strait of Hormuz, are keeping central banks cautious. Markets are pricing rate rises, not cuts.

Eurogroup starts the race to succeed Lagarde at the ECB

Euro-zone finance ministers met today for a first assessment of the candidates to lead the European Central Bank (ECB). Spain has nominated Pablo Hernández de Cos, now head of the Bank for International Settlements. The Netherlands has nominated Klaas Knot, former head of the Dutch central bank. Analysts see Knot as slightly more hawkish (favouring tighter policy) and de Cos as slightly more dovish, though the gap is modest. Reports say Christine Lagarde will leave after the February meeting. Nadia Calviño, president of the European Investment Bank, told Bloomberg that the successor must follow Lagarde's approach.

Why it matters: The ECB president steers rates for 350 million people. The choice will also signal how the euro area balances north and south.

For Europe & Italy: The ECB held its deposit rate at 2.50% on 29 October and discussed a hike. Eurostat's October flash estimate of euro-zone inflation was 4.0%, up from 3.8% in September (reported by StockAnalysis; I could not confirm it elsewhere). The next ECB meeting is 17 December. Italy's BTP-Bund spread (the yield gap between Italian and German 10-year bonds) is about 106 points, with the BTP at 4.31% and the Bund at 3.24%.

Watch: Any Eurogroup shortlist and the EU leaders' timetable for a decision.

Sources: Bloomberg, Handelsblatt, ECB, StockAnalysis

Fed on hold at 3.75-4%, with US inflation data due Tuesday

The Federal Reserve left rates at 3.75-4% on 28 October, in Kevin Warsh's first meeting as chair. The vote was 10-2, and the two dissenters, Lisa Cook and Beth Hammack, wanted a hike. The Fed raised rates by 25 basis points on 16 September. US 10-year yields are 4.86% and 2-year yields 4.78%.

Why it matters: Midterm results and the next US inflation print will shape whether the 9 December meeting brings another hike. Analysts quoted by Portfolio Adviser call a December hike highly likely. That is a view, not a Fed commitment.

Watch: US inflation data on Tuesday 10 November (per ANSA).

Sources: Nation Thailand, Portfolio Adviser

Italian industry holds up

Intesa Sanpaolo and Prometeia expect industrial turnover to reach a record €1,168 billion, up 0.8% in 2026. Intesa's chief economist Gregorio De Felice says Italian manufactured exports rose by €216 billion between 2015 and 2025, about 53%.

Sources: ANSA, Il Sole 24 Ore

Markets & Finance

European stocks rallied as oil fell on an unconfirmed report of Iranian flexibility on Hormuz. The snapshot shows the Euro Stoxx 50 at 6,244.98 (+1.21%), the FTSE MIB at 51,030.92 (+1.95%), the DAX at 26,076.95 (+0.99%) and the IBEX 35 at 19,645.70 (+1.43%).

Italian banks lead, Banco BPM jumps on merger news

ANSA reports Banco BPM up 10.2% at midday after a friendly merger proposal from Crédit Agricole, whose shares fell 0.7%. UniCredit rose 5.6% after what ANSA called another record quarterly result. Intesa Sanpaolo gained 1.8% after regulators cleared its public offer (OPAS) for Monte dei Paschi (MPS), also up 1.8%. The acceptance period starts 24 November. Unipol rose 2.5% and Bper 1.9%.

Why it matters: Bank consolidation is reshaping Italy's sector. Share prices now reflect expected deal premiums, which are expectations, not completed outcomes.

Watch: The start of the MPS acceptance period on 24 November, and how Banco BPM's board responds.

Sources: ANSA

Tech selloff steadies after a rough week; Nvidia in focus

The S&P 500 (7,376.86) fell 2.68% last week, its worst week since April 2025 according to Bloomberg, and the Nasdaq 100 fell 4.91%. US futures are up 0.7% as buyers return. Nvidia is under pressure after CEO Jensen Huang admitted an affair with a woman identified in reports as a suspected Chinese spy. Bloomberg puts the damage to Nvidia's market value at about $200 billion. Asia took a bigger hit: over the week the KOSPI fell 14.34%, the Nikkei 7.13% and Taiex 7.25%. The VIX, Wall Street's fear gauge, is at 23.22.

Other moves: Gold is $4,130 (+4.05% w/w). Bitcoin is $74,554 (-7.28% w/w). EUR/USD is about 1.12. Akamai is seeking $2.2 billion in convertible bonds.

Sources: Bloomberg, Bloomberg, Bloomberg

Trade, Tariffs & Sanctions

China extends its tariff pause on US goods until January

Beijing will keep suspended its additional 24% tariff on US goods for another two months. This formalises a leaders' decision to prolong the trade truce to January. The 10% tariff stays in force, Bloomberg reports.

Why it matters: The US and China agreed a one-year truce in late 2025, and this extension avoids a snap-back of Chinese tariffs. The short two-month horizon keeps both sides under pressure.

Market impact: Exporters and chipmakers exposed to China remain sensitive to headlines. The CNY is steady, with USD/CNH near 6.67.

Watch: Whether the truce is extended again in January.

Sources: Bloomberg

Democrats' new Congress may target Trump's tariffs

After the 3 November midterms, the FT argues that Democrats may be content with reversing Trump's duties on Canada. Bloomberg Economics says voters signalled populist priorities. Tariffs are set largely by presidential executive action, so Congress's power to reverse them is limited.

For Europe & Italy: US tariffs on EU goods remain a risk for Italian exporters, but nothing in today's reporting changes the EU-US terms.

Sources: FT, Bloomberg

Supply chains: cutting dependence on Chinese batteries

BMW will buy battery cells from Samsung and LG Energy Solution to reduce its reliance on China. Handelsblatt reports that China dominates battery supply chains, which has become a risk for Ukraine's drone war and for German and EU defence production.

Sources: Handelsblatt, Handelsblatt

No new sanctions package surfaced in today's sources.

Energy & Critical Minerals

Oil falls on unconfirmed Hormuz signals

Brent fell about 3.5% to roughly $94.7 at midday, per ANSA. The snapshot shows it at $94.39 (-4.0% on the day, -9.9% on the week), with WTI at $87.69. The fall followed an unconfirmed report that Iran offered openings on its demands over the Strait of Hormuz. President Trump told CNN that large-scale strikes on Iran are "highly unlikely" and depend on Tehran signing a "very solid agreement". ANSA also cites Iranian President Pezeshkian saying Khamenei ordered an end to the stalemate with the US (an Iranian official claim).

Why it matters: Hormuz carried about a fifth of global oil and LNG before the conflict began in late February. Brent peaked near $110 earlier this year, so prices still carry a large risk premium.

Market impact: European energy stocks fell (Eni -0.7%, Tenaris -0.7%), while airlines and industrials benefited.

Watch: Official confirmation or denial from Tehran or Washington.

Sources: ANSA

European gas: storage is the real problem

Dutch TTF gas (the European benchmark) is about €84/MWh (-11% on the week). That is still high. The IEA says EU storage entered winter at its lowest level since 2013. About 74.6% was full on 1 November, according to one analysis. Bloomberg says stocks could be the lowest in more than a decade by spring, which would make next summer's refilling harder and more expensive.

For Europe & Italy: Italy depends on gas for power and heating, so high prices feed industrial costs and inflation.

Sources: Bloomberg, WAM/IEA, ANSA

COP31 opens in Antalya under a weak backdrop

UN climate talks begin in Antalya, Turkey. The FT describes a "terrible backdrop" and says Europe is lowering its ambitions. Turkey wants commitments on AI that supports climate action, but MIT Technology Review argues the climate case for AI has not been made.

Metals: Copper is $6.31/lb (+1.5% on the day, -3.6% on the week). Prysmian, an Italian cable maker, rose 3.4%.

Sources: FT, MIT Technology Review

VI Outlook

Market Implications

Asset or sector	Likely pressure	Driver	Already priced in?
Italian banks	Up	Consolidation (Crédit Agricole–Banco BPM, Intesa–MPS offer), record results	Partly: BPM +10% in a day
Defence	Mixed	Abu Dhabi talks vs. hybrid attacks and capital inflows	Largely
Energy (Eni, Tenaris)	Down	Brent below $95 on Hormuz hopes	Partly: Eni and Tenaris -0.7%
Autos	Mixed	Lower oil helps; China dependence on batteries and rare earths	Little
Luxury	Mixed	US–China truce extension vs. tariff uncertainty	Little
Utilities	Mixed	Gas near €85/MWh, storage worries	Partly
BTP–Bund spread	Flat	106–108 points, stable	Yes
Rates	Up	Fed on hold at 3.75–4%, ECB hike debated, US CPI on Tuesday	Partly
EUR/USD	Mixed	Hawkish Fed vs. lower energy costs for Europe	Yes (about 1.12)
Oil	Down, with a volatile path	Unconfirmed Iranian flexibility	Partly: Brent -4% on the day
Gas	Up	Low storage; TTF opened +1.2%	Partly
Gold	Up	Geopolitics, $4,130 (+4% on the week)	Largely
Tech/AI	Mixed	Nvidia probe, Google TPU rivalry, rebound after the selloff	Partly

Asset or sector	Likely pressure	Driver	Already priced in?
Emerging markets	Mixed	Asian equities fell sharply last week; Brazil rate expectations rising	Partly

Today's rally is an oil-and-banks story. Brent fell on reports without a named source, and the banks rose on specific deals. Both are expectations, not completed outcomes.

The next test is US inflation on Tuesday. A hot reading would strengthen the case for another Fed hike in December and could push yields and the spread higher. Nvidia is the main equity risk, because a US move on chip exports before the Xi–Trump meeting would hit chip stocks.

Confirmed Iranian concessions would push oil lower. A Houthi attack on Saudi infrastructure or a breakdown of diplomacy would reverse today's drop.

Market Opportunities & Risks

Educational overview, not advice. Every theme below has a downside.

Italian banks and consolidation

Driver: Record profits, the Intesa-MPS offer and the Crédit Agricole move on Banco BPM. **Exposure:** Bank stocks, Italian bank ETFs, sector funds. **Risks:** Deals can fail, political or regulatory intervention is possible, and bank earnings depend on rates and on the BTP spread. **Horizon:** Medium term. **Priced in?** Partly, since BPM jumped 10% in one day.

AI and semiconductors after a sharp drawdown

Driver: The Nasdaq 100 fell 4.9% in a week. Nvidia faces a China-linked spying probe, and Google is launching new TPU chips as a rival. A JPMorgan Private Bank strategist says semiconductors are the "epicentre" of the drawdown but that earnings assumptions look "reasonably valued". **Exposure:** Semiconductor ETFs and a few giant stocks. **Risks:** Heavy concentration, political and regulatory shocks, and high valuations with rates rising. **Horizon:** Long term, with high short-term volatility.

Bonds and BTPs when rates may rise

Driver: The Fed has hiked and the ECB debated it. The BTP yields 4.31%, with a 106-point spread over Germany. **Exposure:** Government bonds, bond ETFs. **Risks:** Rising yields push prices of longer bonds down, and energy-driven inflation erodes real returns. **Priced in?** The spread is calm, but a surprise in US inflation could change that.

Oil, gas and geopolitics

Driver: Hormuz headlines swing Brent by 3-4% a day. **Exposure:** Energy stocks, commodity funds, airlines on the other side. **Risks:** A deal could push prices down quickly, and a breakdown could send them sharply up. **Horizon:** Very short term, headline-driven.

Investing basics: concentration

Diversification means not letting one stock, sector or theme decide your result. This week shows why. Emerging markets have had a strong year, but Bloomberg notes much of it came from a handful of AI-linked stocks. When a single story such as Nvidia wobbles, many "different" funds fall together. Check what is actually inside a fund before assuming it is spread out.

Sources: Bloomberg, Bloomberg, Bloomberg, ANSA

Scenarios

Iran, Hormuz and oil

- **Base case:** Talk of a deal continues without a signed agreement. Brent stays volatile in a $90–100 range. This is the most likely outcome.
- **Upside:** Tehran or Washington confirms a framework and shipping through Hormuz normalises. Oil and gas fall further and Italian inflation pressure eases. Unlikely in the next week.
- **Downside:** The IAEA monitoring dispute and Houthi strikes (such as the one on the Aramco tower in Riyadh) derail talks. Brent returns toward $100 or above. Plausible.

- **Signposts:** An official statement from Tehran, Washington or Oman, the IAEA Board's response, and Saudi retaliation.

Ukraine talks in Abu Dhabi

- **Base case:** Talks continue without a breakthrough, and strikes on energy and refineries go on. Likely.
- **Upside:** Europeans get a real seat at the table and a framework on security guarantees emerges. Unlikely soon.
- **Downside:** Russia holds to its demand that Ukraine leave Donbas, and Europe is sidelined. This would harden Western sanctions and defence spending. Plausible.
- **Signposts:** The EU officials' role, any ceasefire or energy-strike pause, and the Kremlin's statements.

Nvidia, export controls and the Xi–Trump meeting

- **Base case:** The board probe continues and the House committees press for briefings. The stock is volatile but no export action follows before the meeting. Likely.
- **Upside:** Nvidia's statement that no secrets were compromised holds. The truce deepens at Shenzhen. Possible.
- **Downside:** The Justice Department's Megaspeed investigation widens and Washington tightens chip curbs. Beijing retaliates and the truce is strained. Plausible.
- **Signposts:** The House briefing (reportedly around 18 November), the Justice Department's findings, and any board action on Huang.

What to Watch

Date	Event	Why it matters
Mon 9 – Tue 10 Nov	G7 foreign ministers, Paris	Tajani said cyber countermeasures will be discussed; also Iran and Ukraine
Tue 10 Nov	Italy's national public-order and security committee meets	Response to the hacker leak

Date	Event	Why it matters
Tue 10 Nov, 14:30 Italy time	US October CPI	Shapes the Fed's 9 December decision and bond yields
10–11 Nov (reported)	US–Ukraine–Russia talks, Abu Dhabi	Whether the EU gets a seat
11–12 Nov	COP31 leaders' segment, Antalya (conference runs 9–20 Nov)	Climate finance under pressure
Fri 13 Nov (single source)	US producer prices (PPI)	Inflation pipeline
Fri 13 Nov (unconfirmed)	ULA Vulcan return to flight	Launch date depends on range approval
18–19 Nov (reported, just outside the 7 days)	APEC summit and Xi–Trump meeting, Shenzhen	Tariffs, rare earths, chip curbs

Explained

The BTP–Bund spread

- **What it is:** The gap between the yields on Italian and German 10-year bonds. Germany is the euro area's safest borrower, so the gap measures the extra return investors demand for Italian risk.
- **How it works:** A yield rises when a bond's price falls. If investors worry about Italy's debt or politics, they sell BTPs, the yield rises, and the spread widens. Higher spreads raise the state's borrowing cost, which feeds into banks' funding costs.
- **Analogy:** The extra interest a bank charges a riskier borrower than a safer one.
- **Today:** The 10-year BTP yields about 4.31% and the Bund 3.24%, giving a spread of about 106 points.
- **Key number:** 106 basis points, where 100 basis points equal one percentage point.

Takeover bids in Italian banking

- **What it is:** A takeover bid (OPAS, a mixed public offer) is a public offer to shareholders to buy or swap their shares. A friendly merger proposal is made to the board.
- **How it works:** The bidder files with regulators. After approval, an acceptance period opens. Shareholders tender their shares, and the bid succeeds only if enough accept.
- **Analogy:** An auction in which everyone is told the price in advance.
- **Today:** Intesa's offer for MPS was cleared, with acceptance opening 24 November. Banco BPM rose about 10% on Crédit Agricole's proposal.
- **Key number:** 24 November.

Export controls on AI chips

- **What it is:** US rules that limit which advanced chips can be sold to China.
- **How it works:** Washington licenses sales. Intermediaries who rent chip capacity abroad can create loopholes, which is why brokers such as Megaspeed attract scrutiny.
- **Analogy:** A lock on a door that someone may be renting out the key to.
- **Today:** The Nvidia affair has revived questions about who accessed the chips.
- **Key number:** About $200bn of Nvidia market value lost.

Fiscal truce and tariff suspension

- **What it is:** A temporary pause in tariffs agreed between leaders.
- **How it works:** Each side suspends retaliation for a fixed period. Deadlines force repeated renewals.
- **Analogy:** A ceasefire that must be renewed.
- **Today:** China keeps a 24% extra tariff suspended to January and maintains a 10% rate.
- **Key number:** 10 January 2027.

Glossary

- **Hormuz:** The narrow strait through which about a fifth of global oil and LNG passed before the war.
- **Brent:** The international benchmark price for crude oil.
- **TTF:** The Dutch gas price that serves as Europe's gas benchmark.
- **ECB:** The European Central Bank, which sets interest rates for the euro area.
- **Eurogroup:** The monthly meeting of the euro-area finance ministers.
- **IAEA:** The UN nuclear watchdog.
- **NoName057(16):** A pro-Russian hacktivist group known for denial-of-service attacks.
- **GRU:** Russia's military intelligence agency.
- **Z-Pentest:** A hacking group that the US Justice Department says Russian military intelligence "founded, financed and directed".
- **PNRR:** Italy's national recovery plan, funded by the EU recovery fund.
- **TPU:** Google's tensor processing unit, an AI chip.
- **APEC:** The Asia-Pacific Economic Cooperation forum.
- **Houthis:** Iran-aligned rebels who control much of Yemen.

Sources: UNFCCC COP31 schedule, Council of the EU, Ecofin 9 November, French foreign ministry on the G7 meeting, Investinglive on APEC Shenzhen

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